

Typing Polytonic Ancient Greek on macOS

Using Keyman + GreekClassical Keyboard

This tutorial assumes you know the Greek alphabet and what breathings, accents, iota subscript, etc. look like. It assumes **no prior experience** installing programs or changing keyboard settings on a Mac.

Step 1: Install Keyman (the keyboard program)

1. Open Safari (or your usual web browser) and go to:
<https://keyman.com/mac/>
2. Click the large **Download Keyman for macOS** button.
3. When the download finishes, find the file (it ends in `.dmg`) in your **Downloads** folder and **double-click** it.
4. A new window will open. **Double-click** the **Install Keyman** icon inside that window.
5. Follow the on-screen prompts and click **Install** when asked.
6. Keyman will finish installing. You can close the installer window when it's done.

Important macOS Security Note

On newer versions of macOS you may see a warning that the app is from an unidentified developer or that it needs permissions.

- Go to **System Settings** → **Privacy & Security**.
- Scroll down and click **Allow** or **Open Anyway** next to the Keyman message.
- You may also be asked to allow Keyman to control your computer or monitor input. **Click Allow** — this is required for the keyboard to work.

After installation you should see a small Keyman icon in the top-right menu bar (near the clock, Wi-Fi, and battery icons).

Step 2: Install the GreekClassical Keyboard

1. In your browser, go to:
<https://keyman.com/keyboards/greekclassical>
2. Click the **Install keyboard** button for **macOS**.
3. Keyman should open and install the keyboard automatically.

If the direct button doesn't work:

- Download the `.kmp` file from the page.
- Double-click the `.kmp` file, **or**
- Click the Keyman icon in the menu bar → **Configuration** → **Keyboard Layouts** tab → **Add** and select the downloaded `.kmp` file.

Step 3: Switch to the Greek Keyboard

1. Look at the top-right corner of your screen in the menu bar. You will see an icon that shows the current keyboard (usually something like **ABC**, a flag, or the word “English”).
2. **Click** that icon.
3. In the menu that appears, choose **Keyman** → **Greek Classical** (the exact name may vary slightly).

You can now start typing in Greek in any program (Pages, Word, Google Docs, Notes, etc.).

To switch back to English:

- Click the same menu-bar icon again and choose **English** or **ABC**.

Tip: You only need to do this once per session. macOS will usually remember your last choice.

Step 4: Typing Greek Letters

The layout is **mnemonic** — most letters are on keys that sound or look similar to English.

Common Letter Mappings (lowercase)

- $a \rightarrow \alpha$
- $b \rightarrow \beta$
- $g \rightarrow \gamma$
- $d \rightarrow \delta$
- $e \rightarrow \varepsilon$
- $z \rightarrow \zeta$
- $h \rightarrow \eta$
- $q \rightarrow \theta$
- $i \rightarrow \iota$
- $k \rightarrow \kappa$
- $l \rightarrow \lambda$
- $m \rightarrow \mu$
- n or $v \rightarrow \nu$
- $x \rightarrow \xi$ (or j/c in some cases)
- $o \rightarrow \omicron$
- $p \rightarrow \pi$
- $r \rightarrow \rho$
- $s \rightarrow \sigma$ (becomes ς automatically at end of word)
- $t \rightarrow \tau$
- $u \rightarrow \upsilon$
- $f \rightarrow \phi$
- $y \rightarrow \psi$
- $w \rightarrow \omega$

Capitals: Hold **Shift** (e.g., $\text{Shift} + w \rightarrow \Omega$)

To type a normal Latin letter (e.g., in English words or names):

Type the **backtick** ` first, then the letter.

Example: `a → a (Latin)

Step 5: Adding Diacritical Marks

Type the vowel first, then the diacritic key(s). Order usually doesn't matter.

Diacritic Keys

Mark	Key	Name
` (rough breathing)	[	dasia
' (smooth breathing)	]	psili
ⱱ (iota subscript)		ypogegrammeni
¨ (diaeresis)	+	dialytika
` (grave)	\	varia
´ (acute)	/	oxia
˘ (circumflex)	=	perispomeni
˘ (breve)	-	vrachy
¯ (macron)	_	macron

Examples

- a / → á
- h [/ → ῥ
- w = | → ŵ
- u + / → ú
- a [= | → â (rough + circumflex + iota)

Sigma automatically becomes final ς at the end of a word.

Full official chart (very useful while learning):

<https://help.keyman.com/keyboard/greekclassical>

Step 6: Practice & Tips

1. Open **Notes**, **Pages**, or **TextEdit**.
2. Switch to the Greek keyboard using the menu bar.
3. Type: q e / o s → θεός
4. Type: o i [= o n → οἶον
5. Try combining breathings and accents.

Tips

- Diacritics only attach to vowels (and sometimes ρ).
- If a combination doesn't look right, just keep typing — it often corrects itself.
- You can re-type a diacritic key to remove or adjust it in many

cases.

- Keyman has an on-screen keyboard you can open from the menu bar icon if you get stuck.

Troubleshooting

- Keyboard not appearing in the menu bar?
Click the Keyman icon → **Configuration** and make sure the GreekClassical keyboard is enabled.
- Diacritics not working?
Make sure you're using a font that supports polytonic Greek (most modern fonts do: Times New Roman, Arial, Cal